S1 Table. Reasons for excluding studies on full-text review.

1. Shimokata K, Saka H, Murate T, Hasegawa Y, Hasegawa T. Cytokine content in pleural effusion. Comparison between tuberculous and carcinomatous pleurisy. Chest 1991;99:1103-7.	Only descriptive analysis
2. Yokoyama A, Maruyama M, Ito M, Kohno N, Hiwada K, Yano S. Interleukin 6 activity in pleural effusion; Its diagnostic value and thrombopoietic activity. Chest 1992;102:1055-9.	Not primarily focused on either index test
3. Valdés L, San José E, Alvarez D, Sarandeses A, Pose A, Chomón B, et al. Diagnosis of tuberculous pleurisy using the biologic parameters adenosine deaminase, lysozyme, and interferon gamma. Chest 1993;103:458-65.	Both index tests performed on <95% patients
4. Ogawa K, Koga H, Yang B, Fukuda M, Ohno H, Yamamoto Y, et al. Differential diagnosis of tuberculous pleurisy by the measurement of cytokine concentration in pleural effusion. Kekkaku 1996;71:663-9.	Only descriptive analysis
5. Hyun Joo N, Seog Chea P, Kwang Won K, Hyeong Kwan P, Young Chul K, In Seon C, et al. Diagnostic significance of TNF-alpha in tuberculous and non-tuberculous pleural effusion. Tuber Respir Dis 1997;44:611-20.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
6. Kim YC, Park KO, Bom HS, Lim SC, Park HK, Na HJ, et al. Combining ADA, protein and IFN-gamma best allows discrimination between tuberculous and malignant pleural effusion. Korean J Intern Med 1997;12:225-31.	Both index tests performed on <95% patients
7. Naito T, Ohtsuka M, Ishikawa H, Satoh H, Hasegawa S. Clinical significance of cytokine measurement in pleural effusion. Kekkaku 1997;72:565-72.	Both index tests performed on <95% patients
8. Ogawa K, Koga H, Hirakata Y, Tomono K, Tashiro T, Kohno S. Differential diagnosis of tuberculous pleurisy by measurement of cytokine concentrations in pleural effusion. Tuber Lung Dis 1997;78:29-34.	Both index tests performed on <95% patients
9. Montes Santiago J, Gambón Deza F, Pacheco Carracedo M, Cerdá Mota T. Lymphocyte activation in tuberculous pleuritis. Correlation with adenosine deaminase (ADA), peripheral blood lymphocytes, T cell receptor subfamilies, radiographic extension and levels of Il-6 and soluble Il-2 receptor. Anales de Medicina Interna 1998;15:70-4.	No data for non-tuberculous effusions
10. Valdés L, Alvarez D, San José E, Penela P, Valle JM, García-Pazos JM, et al. Tuberculous pleurisy: a study of 254 patients. Arch Intern Med 1998;158:2017-21.	No data for non-tuberculous effusions
11. Oshikawa K, Sugiyama Y. Elevated soluble CD26 levels in patients with tuberculous pleurisy. Int J Tuberc Lung Dis 2001;5:868-72.	Only descriptive analysis
12. Yamada Y, Nakamura A, Hosoda M, Kato T, Asano T, Tonegawa K, et al. Cytokines in pleural liquid for diagnosis of tuberculous pleurisy. Respir Med 2001;95:577-81.	Both index tests performed on <95% patients
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14. Hiraki A, Aoe K, Eda R, Maeda T, Murakami T, Sugi K, et al. Comparison of six biological markers for the diagnosis of tuberculous pleuritis. Chest 2004;125:987-9.	Only descriptive analysis

15. Tian RX, Gao ZC. Clinical investigation of the diagnostic value of interferon-gamma, interleukin-12 and adenosine deaminase isoenzyme in tuberculous pleurisy. Zhonghua Jie He He Hu Xi Za Zhi 2004;27:435-8.	Overlapping patient dataset
16. Okamoto M, Hasegawa Y, Hara T, Hashimoto N, Imaizumi K, Shimokata K, et al. T-helper type 1/T-helper type 2 balance in malignant pleural effusions compared to tuberculous pleural effusions. Chest 2005;128:4030-5.	Only descriptive analysis
17. Cok G, Parildar Z, Basol G, Kabaroglu C, Bayindir U, Habif S, et al. Pleural fluid neopterin levels in tuberculous pleurisy. Clin Biochem 2007;40:876-80.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
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28. Liu F, Zhang X, Du F, Pan L, Liu Y, Jia H, et al. Comparison of interferon-gamma release assays and adenosine deaminase of pleural fluid for the diagnosis of pleural tuberculosis. Zhonghua Jie He He Hu Xi Za Zhi 2014;37:323-7.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
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41. Ramadan SM, Laz NI, Eissa SAL, Elbatanouny MM, Mohammed MF. Diagnostic dilemma in tuberculous pleural effusion. Egyptian J Chest Dis Tuber 2017;66:327-30.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
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43. Zhang Q, Zhou C. Comparison of laboratory testing methods for the diagnosis of tuberculous pleurisy in China. Sci Rep 2017;7:4549.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
44. Bayhan GI, Sayir F, Tanir G, Tuncer O. Pediatric pleural tuberculosis. Int J Mycobacteriology 2018;7:261-4.	No data for non-tuberculous effusions

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49. Meldau R, Randall P, Pooran A, Limberis J, Makambwa E, Dhansay M, et al. Same-day tools, including Xpert Ultra and IRISA-TB, for rapid diagnosis of pleural tuberculosis: a prospective observational study. J Clin Microbiol 2019;57:e00614-19.	Both index tests performed on <95% patients
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51. Tang Y, Zhang J, Huang H, He X, Zhang J, Ou M, et al. Pleural IFN-gamma release assay combined with biomarkers distinguished effectively tuberculosis from malignant pleural effusion. BMC Infect Dis 2019;19:55.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
52. Zhang M, Niu YR, Liu JY, Wei XS, Wang XR, Ye LL, et al. Interleukin-26 upregulates interleukin-22 production by human CD4+ T cells in tuberculous pleurisy. J Mol Med 2019;97:619-31.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
53. Jiang CG, Wang W, Zhou Q, Wu XZ, Wang XJ, Wang Z, et al. Influence of age on the diagnostic accuracy of soluble biomarkers for tuberculous pleural effusion: a post hoc analysis. BMC Pulm Med 2020;20:178.	Overlapping patient dataset
54. Kim HJ, Ryu S, Choi SH, Seo H, Yoo SS, Lee SY, et al. Comparison of biochemical parameters and chemokine levels in pleural fluid between patients with anergic and non-anergic tuberculous pleural effusion. Tuberculosis 2020;123.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
55. Radhakrishnan P, Mathanraj S. Role of pleural fluid C-reactive protein in the aetiological diagnosis of exudative pleural effusion. J Clin Diag Res 2020;14:OC04-OC7.	Evaluating only one of the two index tests
56. Zhang BY, Yu ZM, Yang QL, Liu QQ, Chen HX, Wu J, et al. Serial anti-tuberculous immune responses during the follow-up of patients with tuberculous pleurisy. Medicine (United States) 2020;99.	No data for non-tuberculous effusions
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